

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH (PAPER-2)

SECTION A

(Attempt **all** questions from this **Section**.)

Question 1

Choose the correct answers to the questions from the given options.

[16]

Do not copy the questions, write the correct answers only.)

- (i) What was the blue bead?
- (a) A piece of perforated glass
 - (b) A round blue pebble
 - (c) A blue marble
 - (d) A blue river rock
- (ii) In H.C. Anderson's story, what forces the Little Match Girl to go about selling matches on the street?
- (a) Poverty
 - (b) Greed
 - (c) The weather
 - (d) Desire for wealth
- (iii) When Luz Long said, 'something must be eating you' he meant that Jesse Owens must be _____.
- (a) hungry for something
 - (b) troubled by something
 - (c) amused by something
 - (d) ashamed of something
- (iv) "We'll keep her a day or two longer; she is so weak and helpless."
Who said these words? To whom?
- (a) Joe Thompson to his wife
 - (b) Jane Thompson to her husband
 - (c) William to his fellow 'rocket-children'
 - (d) The people who saw the Little Match Girl sheltering from the cold
- (v) What was the very first thing that the children noticed when it stopped raining on Venus in Ray Bradbury's story, 'All Summer in a Day'?

- (a) The blazing blue sky
 - (b) The smell of the vegetation
 - (c) The silence
 - (d) The brilliant sunshine
- (vi) Which of the following lines tells us that the poet Wordsworth carried a mental picture of the daffodils?
- (a) 'Ten thousand saw I at a glance'
 - (b) 'They flash upon that inward eye'
 - (c) 'I gazed - and gazed - but little thought'
 - (d) 'Fluttering and dancing in the breeze'
- (vii) Why, according to Maya Angelou, does the caged bird sing?
- (a) To pass the time
 - (b) Because he is hungry for 'fat worms'
 - (c) To voice his protest
 - (d) To communicate with the free bird
- (viii) The line '*The house-roofs seemed to heave and sway,*' in Browning's poem 'The Patriot' means _____.
- (a) 'The roofs of the houses were swaying in the wind.'
 - (b) 'The roofs were so crowded with people that they appeared to be heaving and swaying.'
 - (c) 'The house-roofs were lifted off due to an earthquake.'
 - (d) 'The roofs of houses were blown away in the heavy rain and strong wind.'
- (ix) Identify the list in which Abou Ben Adhem's name appeared right at the top.
- (a) Those who love God.
 - (b) Those who love their fellow human beings.
 - (c) Those who were blessed by the love of God.
 - (d) Those who were considered saints on earth.
- (x) What special human quality does the poem 'Nine Gold Medals' celebrate?
- (a) empathy
 - (b) jealousy
 - (c) rivalry
 - (d) selfishness
- (xi) To whom does Portia compare Bassanio as he steps forward to take the casket test?

- (a) Midas
 - (b) Mercury
 - (c) Hesione
 - (d) Hercules
- (xii) _____ was Portia's faithful servant.
- (a) Bellario
 - (b) Balthazar
 - (c) Launcelot
 - (d) Stephano
- (xiii) Why does Portia ask Shylock if he had arranged for a surgeon to be present at Antonio's trial?
- (a) She wanted to make sure that Antonio would not bleed to death.
 - (b) It was mentioned in the bond.
 - (c) She wanted to stop Bassanio from harming Shylock.
 - (d) She was afraid she would faint at the sight of blood.
- (xiv) According to Lorenzo, a man who is unmoved by music is _____.
- (a) tone-deaf.
 - (b) not to be trusted.
 - (c) self-absorbed.
 - (d) not fit to live.
- (xv) "A Daniel come to judgement! Yea a Daniel"
Who is being described in these words? By whom?
- (a) Shylock, by Portia
 - (b) Bassanio, by Gratiano
 - (c) Antonio, by Portia
 - (d) Portia, by Shylock
- (xvi) What reason does Portia give for refusing the Duke's invitation to dinner?
- (a) She had to hurry back to Belmont before Bassanio's return.
 - (b) She already felt rewarded and satisfied at having saved Antonio.
 - (c) She was afraid of being found out.
 - (d) She had to return to Padua that night.

Comments of Examiners

- (i) Candidates were confused by the word 'blue' in the distractors. The right answer '*a piece of perforated glass*' did not contain the word 'blue' in it.
- (ii) Majority of the candidates answered it correctly.
- (iii) Most candidates got this answer right. A few found the idiomatic expression, '*something must be eating you*' difficult to follow.
- (iv) Many candidates selected option (a) instead of the correct answer (b).
- (v) Many candidates were confused by three of the given distractors. Candidates were often confused because they had overlooked the clue words '*very first*' in the stem of the question. Only those who noticed the clue words 'very first thing' in the question were able to correctly identify the right answer.
- (vi) Some candidates chose (a) and (c) while (b) was the right option. They failed to make the connection between 'mental picture' and 'inward eye'.
- (vii) Most candidates answered it correctly. Some who had not understood the poem chose option (d) '*to communicate with the free bird*'.
- (viii) Several candidates responded to this question correctly. Some answered (a) instead of (b).
- (ix) Several candidates chose option (b) but the correct response was (c). A few candidates seemed to be confused about the lists.
- (x) Most candidates got this answer right.
- (xi) Majority of the candidates answered it correctly. Candidates who were not thorough with textual detail were confused by the given options. Some of them wrote '*Midas*' as the answer (probably because Bassanio mentions Midas in the Casket Scene when he rejects the golden casket).
- (xii) Many candidates got this answer right. Three of the four given options were names of Portia's servants and some candidates who were not thorough with textual detail were confused – they chose Stephano instead of Balthazar.
- (xiii) Many candidates answered this question correctly. Some candidates chose option (b) and others chose (d).

Suggestions for teachers

- Instruct students to read the text thoroughly.
- Description in the prose is very important.
- Conduct quizzes in class as a fun way to ensure that students are able to recall specific details.
- Encourage students to read the text with close attention to detail while preparing for exams rather than just reading a summary of the story.
- Instruct students to be alert in spotting 'clue' words in the questions, which will enable them to correctly identify the best answer.
- Give a classwork activity to the students, putting events in a story in chronological order.
- Explain every line of the poem while teaching it in class, taking care to ensure that students have grasped the meaning of the words as used by the poet.
- Advise students to read the questions carefully before making a choice and not allow the distractors to confuse them.
- Ask students to pay close attention to detail while studying and answering the questions.
- While teaching the text, discuss the purpose/reason for the actions of the characters.
- Insist on paying attention to the accuracy of textual detail.

- (xiv) Most candidates answered it correctly. Candidates who were not thorough with textual detail were confused by the given options. Some candidates chose option (a) and others (d). The right answer was (b).
- (xv) A few candidates were confused and answered (a) '*Shylock, by Portia*', but the right answer was (d) '*Portia, by Shylock*'.
- (xvi) Candidates who were unsure of the text were confused by the given options. Many candidates selected option (a), instead of option (d).

MARKING SCHEME	
Question 1	
(i)	(a) A piece of perforated glass
(ii)	(a) Poverty
(iii)	(b) troubled by something
(iv)	(b) Jane Thompson to her husband
(v)	(c) The silence
(vi)	(b) 'They flash upon that inward eye'
(vii)	(c) To voice his protest
(viii)	(b) 'The roofs were so crowded with people that they appeared to be heaving and swaying.'
(ix)	(c) Those who were blessed by the love of God.
(x)	(a) empathy
(xi)	(d) Hercules
(xii)	(b) Balthazar
(xiii)	(a) She wanted to make sure that Antonio would not bleed to death.
(xiv)	(b) not to be trusted.
(xv)	(d) Portia, by Shylock
(xvi)	(d) She had to return to Padua that night.

SECTION B

(Answer **one or more** questions from this Section.)

DRAMA

(The Merchant of Venice by William Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

*PORTIA: ... Lorenzo, I commit into your hands
The husbandry and manage of my house
Until my lord's return: for mine own part,
I have toward heaven breathed a secret vow
To live in prayer and contemplation,
Only attended by Nerissa here,
Until her husband and my lord's return:*

- (i) Who does Portia refer to as 'my lord'? [3]
Where is her lord?
Why had he left in such haste?
- (ii) What does Portia ask Lorenzo to do? Why does she make this request? [3]
- (iii) Explain in your own words, the 'secret vow' that Portia speaks of. [3]
- (iv) What instructions does Portia give to her servant, a little later in the scene? [3]
- (v) What do we learn of Portia's real intention from her conversation with Nerissa? Which Portia do you prefer - the modest Portia of the Casket scene or the business-like Portia we meet in this scene? [4]
Give **one** reason for your response.

Comments of Examiners

- (i) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. In the second part, instead of 'Venice', some of them wrote 'Venus'. Many candidates answered that her lord was in Belmont.
- (ii) Majority of the candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. The first part of the question was answered correctly by almost all candidates. But some candidates made a mistake while answering the second part. Many of them mentioned about Portia's visit to the monastery with Nerissa to spend their days in prayer and contemplation instead of Portia's plan to go to Venice to assist at Antonio's trial.
- (iii) Although the words '*secret vow*' and the answer itself are to be found in the given extract, many candidates misunderstood the word '*vow*' to mean Portia's plan to disguise herself and travel to Venice to defend Antonio. Instead of explaining the secret vow, many candidates explained Portia's secret plan to save Antonio. Even candidates who answered correctly missed out on key details while explaining the '*secret vow*'.
- (iv) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly and earned marks for their responses. Several candidates failed to understand the question and they wrote about Portia giving instruction to her servants to take care of her house during her absence. Some candidates mentioned that Portia instructed her servant to follow Lorenzo and Jessica's orders in her absence. A few candidates lost marks as they misunderstood the context.
- (v) This question was answered correctly by most of the candidates. It was interesting to note that most of them stated that they preferred the '*business-like Portia*' to the '*modest Portia*'. Justification for this preference ranged from '*Portia is a strong woman*', '*independent person*', '*has a mind of her own*', '*capable of independent thinking*' to '*she dared to break gender stereotypes*'. A few candidates chose both the options ('business-like Portia' and 'modest Portia') but were unable to justify their choice. Most candidates provided an accurate description of Portia's real intention.

Suggestions for teachers

- The action in the play alternates between Venice and Belmont. Train students to be aware of the setting in each scene.
- Frame the questions in three sentences to make it clear for the students.
- Instruct the students to read the extract carefully and check if the answer can be found in it.
- Encourage students to focus on the chronological order of events in the story/drama.
- Reading of the extract with care is important for understanding what is being asked in the question.
- Discuss reason-based questions in the classroom. This will develop the ability to answer such questions in examinations with honesty and confidence.
- Create opportunities in the classroom for students to speak their minds, explore characters, and express their opinions.

MARKING SCHEME

Question 2

(i)	- Bassanio/lover/husband/partner - Gone to Venice/to attend Antonio's trial/court of justice. - Antonio had in a letter asked Bassanio to come and see him one last time before his death/Portia urges him to marry her and leave immediately for Venice/to save Antonio/Bassanio felt responsible for Antonio's condition/Antonio's life was in danger ... Shylock demanded a pound of flesh.
(ii)	- To take charge of the 'husbandry/ manage' of her house to be the master of the house/take care/until her lord returns. OR - Because Bassanio is away and she too is planning to go away from Belmont (or to a Monastery) for some days/She plans to travel to Venice, disguised as a lawyer, with Nerissa to assist at Antonio's trial.
(iii)	- go to a Monastery/church that is two miles away - to live there in prayer and contemplation/meditation - accompanied only by Nerissa - remain there until their husbands' return. <i>(Any three)</i>
(iv)	- travel to Padua very quickly - deliver Portia's letter/to her cousin Dr. Bellario - bring back from Padua the notes/garments he (Dr. Bellario) gives. - go/return as quickly as possible - meet her at the landing place (tranect) the boarding point for the ferry to Venice. <i>(Any three)</i>
(v)	- Portia plans they would disguise themselves as young men – herself as a lawyer and Nerissa as a lawyer's clerk - travel to Venice/to assist at Antonio's trial. - meet with their husbands – (who would not be able to recognise the young ladies as they would be in disguise). <i>(Any two)</i> Accept a plausible justification for either

	- Accept either response ‘modest Portia’ (humble/generous/gracious/virtuous/demure – accept examples/quotes from the casket scene to show she is modest/humble) - Business-like Portia (strong, independent, smart, empowered, fearless, determined, quick thinking)
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Question 3

Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

SHYLOCK: Shall I not have barely my principal?

*PORTIA: Thou shalt have nothing but the forfeiture,
To be so taken at thy peril, Jew.*

- (i) What is the ‘*principal*’ that Shylock asks for? [3]
Why does Portia refuse to give it to him?
- (ii) What is the ‘*forfeiture*’ they are referring to? [3]
What danger (‘*peril*’) would Shylock be in if he took the forfeiture?
- (iii) What further hold does the law of Venice have on Shylock? [3]
- (iv) What concession does Antonio offer to Shylock? [3]
On what condition does he make this offer?
- (v) Why is Shylock in a hurry to leave the courtroom after the trial? [4]
How far can Shylock be blamed for the outcome of the trial?
Give **one** reason for your response.

Comments of Examiners

- (i) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly and earned marks.

Surprisingly many candidates didn't mention the 3000 ducats specifically. Some even confused the '3000 ducats' with the 'pound of flesh'. A number of candidates were unable to answer the second part of the question. Many gave the reason that Portia wanted to save Antonio. Quite a few candidates gave only one reason for Portia's refusal to give Shylock the principal amount.

- (ii) Most candidates who had studied their texts answered all parts of the question correctly. Some candidates did not understand the word 'forfeiture' and stated that it referred to the sum of three thousand ducats. Some were unable to clearly explain the danger that Shylock would face if he claimed his pound of flesh. Important details were missing from some of the answers to the second

part of the question – most only wrote about the confiscation of Shylock's property. Only a few mentioned the possibility of Shylock being put to death if he caused Bassanio's blood to spill.

- (iii) Some candidates understood the question correctly and could answer it correctly. Others were confused and wrote the answer to question (ii) instead. Instead of describing the Venetian law against aliens who conspired against native Venetians, some candidates mentioned about the conditions laid down by Antonio. Some of the candidates were confused between questions (iii) and (iv). Their answers to these questions overlapped. It was observed that many candidates struggled with phrasing the response to this question correctly. They had studied the text but could not recall the specific details.

- (iv) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. Some had trouble recalling the concessions made by Antonio. Candidates were found confused with the meanings of the words 'concessions' and 'condition' although both words were from the text and they should have known their meaning.

- (v) Most candidates answered the question correctly. References to Shylock's guilt, shaming, humiliation were made. An inability to express their thoughts due to a lack of adequate vocabulary was observed in the candidates' response to this question. Few candidates could describe Shylock's feelings as devastated/frustrated/shattered/disappointed/humiliated. They simply stated that Shylock was unable to take revenge. The second part of the question was answered well with a proper reason. Most candidates felt that Shylock was to be blamed for the outcome of the trial. A few felt he was the victim and not the villain.

Suggestions for teachers

- Ask 'why' questions in the classroom to encourage students to explore and discuss alternative reasons for any given character's action. This will help them to think out of the box.
- Teach the meanings of words, especially unfamiliar or archaic words, while teaching the text.
- Advise students to pay attention to details while studying the text.
- Encourage students to read all the questions based on the given extract so that they can answer the accurately and to the point.
- Distinguish between confusing terminology (e.g., 'concession/condition', 'principal/ forfeiture,' etc.) during classroom teaching.

MARKING SCHEME

Question 3

(i)	- The three thousand ducats/sum/amount he had loaned to Bassanio. - Shylock (had been offered the sum/larger sums repeatedly in court and) he had refused the offer in open court. - Shylock had stubbornly demanded his bond/the forfeiture/Shylock said he wanted only justice. (Any two)
(ii)	- A pound of Antonio's flesh (cut from nearest his heart) - If Shylock spilt even one drop of 'Christian' blood/Antonio's blood while cutting out his pound of flesh/if he cut more or less than a pound all his lands and property would be confiscated by the state of Venice/he will die.
(iii)	According to the laws of Venice: - If it could be proved that an alien/foreigner - Had attempted (through direct/indirect means) to kill a citizen of Venice - The offender's wealth and property would be confiscated. - one half given to the State - the other half to his intended victim. - The offender's life lay at the mercy of the Duke – the Duke alone could pardon him, no matter what anyone else said. (Any three)
(iv)	Antonio offers to drop the fine for one half of his possession/to return to Shylock a half of what Shylock had to give to him/ Antonio will keep one half in use/ give it to Lorenzo and Jessica. Conditions: - Shylock was to become a Christian immediately - Shylock was to sign a deed stating that on his death, all his wealth would pass to Lorenzo/his son-in-law and Jessica/his daughter.
(v)	Shylock feels shamed and humiliated / he has lost face / defeated / he feels physically ill/ devastated/ angry/ frustrated/ shattered/ sad/ not happy/ disappointed. Yes, he was largely to blame – stubbornly refused offers of money / refused to be merciful/ insisted on his bond/ tried to kill/ vindictive OR No, he was shamed and humiliated / reacted in anger and desire for revenge / his was a human response.

SECTION C

(Answer **one or more** questions from this Section.)

PROSE – SHORT STORIES

(Treasure Trove – A Collection of Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the following extract from T.S. Arthur's short story, 'An Angel in Disguise' and answer the questions that follow:

"What is to be done with the children?" That was the chief question now. The dead mother would go underground, and be forever beyond all care or concern of the villagers. But the children must not be left to starve.

- (i) Describe the way in which the children's mother died. [3]
What are the factors that led to her death?
- (ii) How do the people of the village treat the woman before her death? [3]
How does their manner change after she dies?
What does their behaviour tell us about human nature?
- (iii) Name the woman's three children. [3]
State *one* fact about each of them that the author mentions at the very beginning of the story.
- (iv) What happens to each of the children after the mother's funeral? [3]
- (v) Which of the three children can be considered the 'Angel in Disguise'? [4]
What does the term '*disguise*' refer to in the context of this story?
How does the child's arrival transform the home she enters?

Comments of Examiners

- (i) The candidates could not distinguish between the two parts of the question. Candidates failed to describe the manner ('how') in which the mother had died. Instead, they listed the causes ('why') for her death. Most candidates named drinking as a factor. Only a few mentioned 'vice' and 'idleness'. They only wrote the mother died due to the excessive consumption of alcohol. They were not able to mention the factors that led to the death of the mother. Many candidates mentioned 'gate/edge/house door/front gate/stairs instead of 'threshold'. Many candidates could not attempt the second sub-part correctly. They wrote only one factor that led to the lady's death while the question mentioned 'factors'- implying that they were required to list more than one.
- (ii) Most candidates were able to describe 'how the villagers treated the mother before/after her death'. However, many were unable to say why ['what this tells us of human nature...?'] there was a change in their manner after her death i.e., the candidates were unable/afraid to draw an inference/afraid to express an opinion. The first two parts of the question were answered well, but many candidates did not fully comprehend the words, 'death touches the spring of humanity' or 'people are compassionate in the face of death'. It was noticed that the candidate often did not know how to answer the sub questions specifically. Instead, they wrote responses that were a page long and the examiners had to wade through that to find the answers.
- (iii) Candidates answered this as one single question. It was easy enough for them to write the names of the three children mentioning at least one fact about each one of them. Some candidates who were unfamiliar with the text struggled to recall the names and often managed only two correct names. Some candidates had trouble with naming the children correctly.
- (iv) Majority of the candidates answered it correctly. However, a few candidates confused the names of the children with the names of the villagers. Others used the word 'adopted' instead of 'taken away' for John and Kate. A few were confused by the names 'farmer Jones' and 'Mrs. Ellis' and used them interchangeably. It was observed that many

Suggestions for teachers

- Ask students to pay attention to the smallest details of the story.
- Encourage students to read the questions carefully – so that they correctly infer what is required in their response.
- Help students in distinguishing between 'HOW' and 'WHY'.
- A thorough knowledge of the text – both literal and metaphorical is required in order to make the right response.
- Teach students to respond to each sub-question separately.
- Encourage more discussion in class – create opportunities in the classroom for students to express their views and challenge/debate opinions that are different from their own.
- Remembering the names of the characters in a story is a basic requirement. Regular quizzes on factual details often help students remember such facts during the examinations.
- Dictation or Spell-Bee competitions should be held in schools to improve their spelling.
- Students should be taught to think beyond the literal meaning.
- Explain important terms with multiple examples and situations.

candidates had trouble spelling the names of the children in the story. E.g., ‘John’ was spelt as ‘Jhon’ and ‘Ellis’ as ‘Alis’.

- (v) Almost all candidates named Maggie as the ‘Angel in Disguise’. Many candidates struggled to explain the word ‘disguise’ in the context of the story; they failed to mention Maggie’s disability, her sickness/her spinal injury and simply stated that Maggie came disguised as an angel. Most candidates failed to infer that the word ‘disguise’ was a reference to Maggie’s disability/injured spine/bedridden/sick/wretched state. Many candidates took the question quite literally and provided the meaning of the word ‘disguise’. Most candidates were able to describe the difference in the Thompson’s home before/after Maggie’s arrival. It was observed that candidates who were not so well-prepared mentioned all the three names in the first part of the question.

MARKING SCHEME	
Question 4	
(i)	- Fell on the threshold of her house/ in a drunken fit (in the presence of her children) - Idleness / vice / intemperance <i>(Any two)</i>
(ii)	- They scoffed at her /despised / denounced her while she was alive/ looked down on her/ treated her badly. - Pity / sorrow (replaced their anger and denunciation) - Death touches the spring of our common humanity/ people are compassionate in the face of death/ forgive and forget/ fickleness of humans / fleeting sentiments.
(iii)	- John + Kate + Maggie - Description of ANY TWO children/ One child with full, correct description John + oldest – boy of twelve – stout lad – able to earn his living with any farmer. Kate – between ten and eleven – bright active girl – if in good hands she would blossom into a clever person. Maggie – youngest – hopelessly diseased / injured spine after a fall from a window.
(iv)	- John/ the boy/ the brother was taken away by farmer (Jones) in his wagon. - Kate / the girl/ sister was taken away by Mrs. Ellis - Maggie left alone / abandoned / eventually carried home by Joe Thompson/ adopted and taken in by Joe Thompson.
(v)	- Maggie - Her disability / injured spine / she was bedridden and seemingly ‘useless’/ a sick/ miserable/ helpless child. Before Maggie’s arrival, Jane Thompson was bad tempered / selfish / ‘vinegar tempered’/ childless OR before her arrival the home was a dark, cold place After Maggie arrives – her humility, gratitude and pathetic condition filled Jane’s heart with love and tenderness OR the home was filled with blessing and light.

Question 5

Read the following extract from Ray Bradbury's short story, 'All Summer in a Day' and answer the questions that follow:

"Margot"

They stood as if someone had driven them like so many stakes into the floor. They looked at each other and then looked away. They glanced out at the world that was raining now and raining and raining steadily. They could not meet each other's glances. Their faces were solemn and pale. They looked at their hands and feet, their faces down.

- (i) Who is Margot? [3]
How does the author describe her?
- (ii) Who are 'They'? [3]
Where do they live?
Mention *any one* reality of the planet on which they live.
- (iii) What **two words** would you use to describe what the children were experiencing in the above extract? [3]
Why does the mention of Margot's name affect them in this way?
- (iv) What event had the children awaited eagerly that day? [3]
What made this event special?
Why did this event mean so much to Margot in particular?
- (v) What is the central theme of Bradbury's story, 'All Summer in a Day'? [4]
What important lesson have the children learnt from this experience?
Why do you suppose the story is said to end on a note of hope?

Comments of Examiners

- (i) Candidates unfamiliar with textual detail, found it difficult to describe Margot. Some candidates were unable to say more than, 'a girl/ a little girl' in response to the first part of this question. Most candidates were able to provide a physical description of Margot, but very few mentioned about her personality. Some candidates did not describe her appearances/ personality; they only mentioned that she was a nine-year-old girl living on planet Venus. In the third part of the question, some candidates actually gave a factual description of the planet Venus (as the Earth's neighbouring planet, as being closer to sun, hotter than the Earth etc.) ...! Students were expected to use words like 'withdrawn' / 'alienated' / 'introvert' / 'passionate about the Sun' in their descriptions of Margot.
- (ii) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. In many instances, the candidates misspelt 'Venus' as 'Venice'! Candidates who had studied the text used descriptions such as 'lived in underground tunnels / the sun appeared once in seven years.' To describe the lifestyle of the people on Venus. Candidates were expected to use phrases such as 'rained incessantly' and 'violent storms' to describe Venus, however, it was disappointing to note that most candidates lacked the vocabulary to express their thoughts.
- (iii) Many candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. Several candidates 'borrowed' the words 'solemn' and 'pale' from the extract to describe what the children were feeling. Once again this reflects the candidates' lack of appropriate vocabulary – 'pale' and 'solemn' cannot be used to describe an experience! It also reveals an inability on their part to think/ express an opinion/ infer meaning from the context. They had no trouble answering 'why' the children felt this way as this only required the ability to recall the answer. Candidates who had fared poorly in this question, struggled to write about the feelings of guilt, shame etc. Some candidates wrote about the children's excitement at the prospect of seeing the sun after 7 long years. Only a few could answer the second part of the question correctly.
- (iv) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly.
- (v) The central theme of 'bullying' was identified by most candidates. Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. Some missed the point of the story altogether and stated that the appearance of the sun on Venus was the theme. Others mentioned science as the theme of the story. Some candidates were unable to explain why the story ended on a note of hope. Most of them felt that the 'hope' was Margot's prospective return to the Earth/ that the children could look forward to seeing the sun again after seven years.

Suggestions for teachers

- Encourage students to pay close attention to textual detail – especially descriptive details.
- Teach students to write answers to all sub-parts separately.
- Ensure that students spot their own mistakes and correct them.
- Encourage more discussion in class by creating opportunities for students to express their views and challenge/ debate opinions that are different from their own.
- Ask students to identify mood/ feelings of the characters in the story/ drama as the story unfolds.
- Discuss concepts such as 'theme', 'tone' and 'mood' in the classroom so that the students understand these terms and are able to respond appropriately when questioned on them.

MARKING SCHEME

Question 5

(i)	- Margot – 9-year-old girl / protagonist of ‘All Summer in a Day’ who lived on Venus/ moved from Earth to Venus 5 years ago/ as a four year-old. Description (<i>any two</i> from either physical/ personality) Physical: frail; pale (<i>see text:</i> washed out blue eyes, pale lips and light coloured hair) /like an old photograph that had lost all its colour/ soft, faint voice/ like a ghost. Personality: withdrawn/ kept to herself/ incredibly passionate about the sun/ different from the others/ introvert/ victim of bullying/ alienated
(ii)	‘They’ = children of the ‘rocket men and women’ / Margot’s classmates/ other children on Venus - on Venus - it rained incessantly / violent storms/ they lived in underground tunnels / the sun only appeared once in 7 years/ sun shone very briefly. <i>(Any other acceptable response – drawn from the text)</i>
(iii)	- Guilt / shame / remorse / regret / felt sorry/ felt bad for what they had done <i>(any two)</i> - They had locked Margot in a closet / bullied Margot / made her miss the brief summer (when they knew how much it meant to her) <i>(any one)</i>
(iv)	- The appearance of the sun - It happened only once in 7 years/ they were only two when the sun appeared last They did not remember seeing the sun - Margot had been living on the earth and she needed the sun/ She was used to seeing the sun everyday/ she could not bear to live without it/ she was eagerly waiting to see the sun.
(v)	- Bullying / Cruelty of children/ importance of the sun/ darker side of human nature/ jealousy/ envy - What they considered ‘fun’ had seriously harmed /hurt Margot/wrong to bully someone / not to be swept along with their peers/ that they could never undo what they had done/ empathise/ realisation. - Ends on a note of hope because the children feel guilt / shame / remorse / sorry for their action – out of this comes repentance and a reforming of their lives/ empathy/ realization/ may treat her better.

SECTION D

(Answer **one or more** questions from this Section.)

POETRY

(Treasure Trove – A Collection of Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the following extract from William Wordsworth's poem, 'Daffodils' and answer the questions that follow:

*When all at once I saw a crowd,
A host, of golden daffodils;
Beside the lake, beneath the trees,
Fluttering and dancing in the breeze.*

- (i) Wordsworth uses the words, 'wandered' and 'lonely' to describe himself in the opening lines of the poem. [3]
What mood do these words convey?
What led to a change in his mood?
- (ii) How does Wordsworth describe the sight that met his eyes? [3]
Give a brief description of what the poet saw.
- (iii) To what does the poet compare this sight? [3]
How is this comparison appropriate?
- (iv) What does the poet mean when he says, 'Ten thousand saw I at a glance'? [3]
Find **two** other words in the given extract that create the impression of large numbers.
- (v) What immediate effect did this sight have on Wordsworth? [4]
How did it affect him in the long-term?
What does this poem tell us about Wordsworth's attitude to Nature?

Comments of Examiners

- (i) Candidates were unable to correctly identify Wordsworth's mood at the start of the poem. They simply repeated the words- 'wandered' and 'lonely' from the question to describe the poet's mood. They were unable to elaborate further on these words. This might indicate a poor vocabulary or simply the fact that they study without much thought. They readily identified the reason for the poet's change in mood – simple recall. Again, this points to an inability/ unwillingness to apply their minds and imaginations while answering questions. Many candidates failed to give specific reasons to explain the words 'wandered' and 'lonely' used by the poet.
- (ii) Most candidates answered both parts of the question correctly.
- (iii) Majority of the candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. A few said that the poet compared the daffodils to the 'dancing waves.'
- (iv) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly and scored full marks for their responses. Quite a few candidates added that Wordsworth was comparing the daffodils to the waves. Many candidates simply mentioned that it was an example of a hyperbole only. They did not explain the line. A few candidates wrote the answer for the second sub-part incorrectly, as they identified '*ten-thousand*' as one of the words that creates the impression of large numbers.
- (v) Several candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. They were aware that Wordsworth was a nature poet - that Nature was his inspiration and that he believed in Nature's restorative powers/ it heals. A few candidates had trouble differentiating between 'immediate' effect and 'long term' effect.

Suggestions for teachers

- Encourage students to recognize and justify the mood/ tone used by the poet.
- Students must be taught how to understand a question and how to answer every part of it
- Train students to answer the sub-parts of each question separately.

MARKING SCHEME

Question 6

(i)	• aimless / without direction/ alone / solitude / sad / depressed/ dejected/ pensive/ melancholic (any two) • The sight of a field of golden daffodils.
(ii)	• Flowers everywhere/ crowd/ host of flowers/ thousands of daffodils/ growing beside the lake/ beneath the trees/ along the margin of a bay/ the golden flowers appeared to be dancing/ fluttering/ tossing their heads in the breeze/ never-ending line/ beside the sparkling waves/ compares them to stars / makes use of similes /hyperbole/imagery to describe. (any three)
(iii)	• <i>stars</i> in Milky Way Galaxy/ <i>stars</i> in the sky • because Milky Way is so full of stars all crowded together that it seems like milk splashed across the universe/ continuous/ never ending line • Similarly, the field was so crowded with daffodils that it looked like a galaxy of golden stars/ thousands of daffodils

	Stars twinkle and shine.... Daffodils are shiny and golden
(iv)	(Hyperbole) not literally ten thousand, he means that he saw countless flowers / thousands and thousands of flowers. - Host - Crowd
(v)	- Uplifted / spirit soared /happy lifted him out of sadness and depression instantly/A poet could not but be gay in such a jocund company/ cheerful/ joyous / calming and restorative. - Long term – every time he felt low, depressed he would call to mind/ recall/ remember/ imagine/ the field of golden daffodils and the mental picture/ ‘inward eye’ of the dancing flowers lifted his mood and made his heart ‘dance with pleasure’ like the daffodils / peaceful (before... after effect). - Wordsworth considered Nature his inspiration/ He believed that Nature could inspire/ heal/ and restore the human mind/ Nature lover.

Question 7

Read the following extract from Maya Angelou’s poem, ‘I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings’ and answer the questions that follow:

*But a caged bird stands on the grave of dreams
his shadow shouts on a nightmare scream
his wings are clipped and his feet are tied
so he opens his throat to sing.*

- (i) How does Angelou describe the state of the free bird in the opening lines of the poem? [3]
- (ii) Give a brief description of the caged bird’s physical and mental condition. [3]
- (iii) Explain the phrase, ‘grave of dreams’ in your own words. [3]
What does the caged bird sing about?
- (iv) The ‘free bird’ and the ‘caged bird’ in the poem represent different groups of people. Name them. [3]
Name *any one* group of people that you would call ‘caged birds’ in today’s world.
- (v) What does the title of poem, ‘I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings’, tell us about Maya Angelou’s life? [4]

Mention *two* ways in which the world of the caged bird differs from that of the free bird.

Comments of Examiners

- (i) Most candidates answered the question correctly. A few candidates described the ‘caged bird’ instead of the ‘free bird’. Perhaps they had only studied a description of the ‘caged bird’. A few candidates mentioned ‘fat worms’ and ‘trade winds soft’ which are mentioned later in the poem and not in the opening lines.
- (ii) Most candidates answered the question correctly. However, some candidates described the physical condition (wings clipped/feet tied/ locked in small cage etc.) but did not describe the bird’s mental condition. The question required them to describe both.
- (iii) Most candidates answered all parts of the question correctly. Some candidates had difficulty in explaining the phrase ‘grave of dreams.’ As the phrase wasn’t clearly understood by them, a few did not attempt this question.
- (iv) The candidates’ responses to this question were both gratifying and enlightening. The responses showed that our young people are thinking critically and responding with sensitivity. Their response to ‘Name one group of people that you would call caged birds today’ elicited a range of insightful answers that included, ‘transgender’, ‘gay people’, ‘Dalits’, ‘girls’, ‘village women’, ‘Ukrainians’ etc.
- (v) Most candidates answered both parts of the question correctly. They were familiar with details of Angelou’s early years and her struggle as an activist, feminist and a person of colour and made references to all this in their responses. Some candidates mentioned only one difference instead of two in response to the second part of this question. Several candidates mentioned the differences between white Americans and African Americans.

Suggestions for teachers

- Train students to read the question carefully and understand it—avoid answering in haste.
- Advise students to read all parts of the question very carefully and respond accordingly.
- Instruct students to use the reading time at the start of the examination to carefully read the question paper, paying attention to details.
- Discuss such questions in the classroom to provide students with an opportunity to share their points of view.
- Encourage meaningful, associative, and active learning.
- Provide a brief background on the poet/writer, highlighting aspects of their life relevant to a proper study and understanding of the poem/story.

MARKING SCHEME

Question 7

(i)	A free bird: - Leaps on the back of the wind - Floats downstream till the current ends - Dips his wing in the orange sun rays - Dares to claim the sky/ exploring the sky for freedom (Any three)				
(ii)	Physical condition: clipped wings/ tied feet/ Restricted movement/ narrow cage Mental Condition: filled with rage / furious / angry / frustrated /fear of the unknown/ restricted movement / dreams of / yearns for freedom				
(iii)	- grave of dreams – state of utter despair / even dreams have died and been buried/ hopelessness/ desperate (<i>any synonym</i>) - unknown things/ things it longs for / yearns for/ freedom/ dreams (<i>any two</i>)				
(iv)	Free bird – People who enjoyed unrestricted freedom in society e.g., men / white people/ privileged Caged bird – People who had their freedom restricted, curtailed e.g., People of colour / African – Americans / not so privileged/ Women Other ‘Caged birds’: Please accept any plausible response such as women / poor / persons belonging to low caste/ child labourers/ transgenders/ prisoners etc.				
(v)	- Title tells us she has first-hand experience (<i>I Know Why...</i>) of being caged/ she was abused/ victim of gender/ racial discrimination/ traumatic childhood - She has experience and can therefore empathise <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <thead> <tr> <th style="text-align: center;">Caged bird</th><th style="text-align: center;">Free bird</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td> - Can only walk about its cage. - Limited movement. - Dreams have been crushed. - Can only sing of freedom, ‘things unknown but longed for still’ – not really experience it. - Bars limit its world. - Has no access to resources/ opportunities. - No choices. </td><td> - Can fly freely. - Unrestricted access to all it wishes for. - Can dream. - Experience freedom - No cage to limit its freedom. - Has access to resources like trade winds/ fat worms. - Plenty of choices </td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Caged bird	Free bird	- Can only walk about its cage. - Limited movement. - Dreams have been crushed. - Can only sing of freedom, ‘things unknown but longed for still’ – not really experience it. - Bars limit its world. - Has no access to resources/ opportunities. - No choices.	- Can fly freely. - Unrestricted access to all it wishes for. - Can dream. - Experience freedom - No cage to limit its freedom. - Has access to resources like trade winds/ fat worms. - Plenty of choices
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GENERAL COMMENTS

Topics
found
difficult/
confusing by
candidates

(a) Topics/Concepts found difficult:

- Questions based on the theme/ mood conveyed by the lines of the poem/stories.
- Figures of speech and other literary devices.
- Many candidates were unable to give factual information correctly.
- **Question 6 (i):** The word 'mood' was not correctly understood.
- **Question 1 (iii):** Question that tested knowledge of idiomatic language.
- **Question 5 (iii) & (v):** Questions that tested critical thinking/ inferential skills
- Some question that the candidates had a little difficulty with:
Question 2(iii), Question 4 (v), Question 5 (iii) & (v), Question 6 (iii) & (iv), Question 7 (v).

(b) Topics/Concepts between which candidates were confused:

- Portia's going to Venice to help Antonio was confused with her going to the monastery.
- Meaning of '*forfeiture*' and the '*penalty*' that Shylock would have to pay.
- In '*All summer in a Day*' the candidates were confused about the theme of the story.
- There was a lot of confusion in the spelling of 'Venus' and 'Venice'. The two were often used interchangeably.
- In the story '*An Angel in Disguise*', the word 'disguise' was misunderstood by some candidates.
- Some candidates were unable to explain the comparison in the poem '*Daffodils*'.

A red circular graphic with a slight gradient and a shadow, containing the text 'Suggestions for candidates' in white.

Suggestions for candidates

- Read and study the text – avoid studying out of summaries/ notes.
- Use the ‘Reading Time’ in the examination hall to read the questions carefully – look for ‘clue’ words embedded in the questions that will help candidates to understand exactly what is required of them.
- Respond with confidence and honesty when asked to express an opinion on any character/ theme etc.
- Pay attention to the details. Several candidates lost marks because they were unable to recall details of the story.
- All descriptions of people, places, sequence of events etc. should be studied in detail.
- Pay attention to the phrasing of a question. Look out for the ‘why’.
- Avoid writing longwinded generalized/ generic answers. While doing so, they tend to miss important points and lose marks.
- It is advisable to write answers to all sub-parts of a question on a fresh line.
- Proper numbering of questions and following the question numbers as shown in the question paper is important.